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ADVANCED WEB DEVELOPMENT
HOMEWORK**

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Information Organization & Structure

The Costco website organizes information mainly through broad product categories that reflect how items are grouped in physical warehouses. Users navigate through high-level sections like Grocery, Electronics, and Home, which then branch into deeper subcategories. This approach supports experienced shoppers but can be confusing for new users because the hierarchy is deep and not always clearly shown on screen.

Showing Complex Data

Costco presents complex product information in a factual and structured way. Product pages display prices, membership requirements, item numbers, shipping conditions, and quantity limits. Instead of using visual summaries or charts, the site relies on text-heavy layouts and structured lists. This ensures accuracy but increases visual density and scanning effort.

Getting Input from the User

User input on the Costco website is handled through standard interaction patterns such as search fields, dropdown menus, checkboxes, and buttons. Users can search for products, apply filters, add items to the cart, and complete checkout forms. Feedback is mostly confirmation-based, with limited real-time validation or intelligent suggestions.

Page Layout & Screen Organization

The layout follows a traditional e-commerce structure with a top navigation bar, a central content area, and a footer. Product listings are shown in grid layouts, while product detail pages are long and scroll-heavy. There is limited use of collapsible sections or step-by-step layouts, which can make pages feel dense.

Navigation & Wayfinding

Navigation is primarily category-driven, using a top menu and internal links. While page titles indicate the current section, the site does not consistently provide breadcrumbs or clear location indicators. This can make it harder for users to understand where they are within the overall site structure.

Design Patterns Used

Costco relies on conservative and well-known design patterns such as product grids, list views, master-detail layouts, and form-based checkout processes. The focus is on consistency and reliability rather than visual innovation, which supports repeat users but feels outdated to some audiences.

UX Implications

The Costco website works well for frequent shoppers who prioritize efficiency and clear pricing. However, new users may experience higher cognitive load due to dense information, minimal guidance, and limited visual hierarchy. Improving wayfinding and simplifying data presentation could enhance usability without changing the core functionality.